The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Granting Fearlessness to All"

Āryasarvābhayapradānāmadhāraṇī · Toh 925 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཐམས་ཅད་ལ་མ་འཇིགས་པ་རབ་ཏུ་སྦྱིན་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Granting Fearlessness to All," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarvābhayapradāna Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phagpa Thamché La Mi Jikpa Rabtu Jinpa Zhejawé Zung, is a short scriptural dhāraṇī, a text centered on a protective incantation taught by the Buddha. It opens in the land of Magadha, where the Blessed One is staying in the rock cave of Videha, king of mountains, near the Mango Grove. There Śakra, lord of the gods, approaches him and explains that the asuras, his longstanding enemies, are causing great harm, and he asks the Buddha to teach him the Dharma that will address this threat. The text belongs to the dhāraṇī literature valued for its power to dispel fear and danger. It is catalogued as Toh 925 in the Kangyur, where it is found among the collected dhāraṇī texts.

In the language of India: āryasarvaabhayapradānāmadhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Granting Fearlessness to All."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, while wandering through the land of Magadha, went to the Mango Grove. Having arrived, he stayed in the rock cave of Videha, king of mountains, at the Mango Grove.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and sat down to one side. Seated to one side, Śakra, lord of the gods, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, the asuras do great harm. Blessed One, since the asuras have long been my hostile enemies, I ask the Blessed One to teach me the Dharma for this."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said this to Śakra, lord of the gods: "Lord of the gods, take up this vidyā-mantra that grants fearlessness to all. It accomplishes every aim. It utterly pacifies all fears. It utterly pacifies all diseases. It neutralizes all poisons. It paralyzes all weapons. It paralyzes all creatures without feet, with two feet, and with four feet. It destroys all enemies. It destroys garuḍas, dānavas, piśācas, apasmāras, unmādas, brahmarākṣasas, bhūtas, vetālas, the bird graha, pūtanas, revatīs, the skanda

graha and skandas, the apasmāra graha, the graha of gods, the graha of nāgas, the graha of yakṣas, the graha of gandharvas, the graha of kinnaras, the graha of vināyakas, and the graha of mātṛkās. It utterly destroys the stealers of vitality, those who eat garlands as food, those who eat fragrances as food, those who eat flowers as food, those who eat incense smoke as food, those who drink blood as food, those who drink pus as food, those who eat filth as food, and those who drink urine as food. It utterly destroys all epidemic fevers, illnesses arising from wind, those arising from bile, those arising from phlegm, and those arising from their combination, as well as beings who behave with violence. It utterly pacifies all fights, disputes, quarrels, and faultfinding.

"I shall explain the vidyā-mantra that grants fearlessness to all:

tadyathā aḍe maḍe pramaḍe prame diri go la me po le bo se mod de bad de kha rad te kha ra ne gra ṇa gra ṇe gra ṇa pra ga ṇe mo ṇe pra ti mo ṇi kā lī pra krā lī caṇḍi ma hā caṇḍe pra ti caṇḍe be ge a ti ba ge so na go na mo hā pra mo hā mo ta pra mo ṭā nā śā ni pra nā śā ni dha ba nī pra dha ba nī ba la ga nī pra ba la ga nī nṛd tya nī pra nrid tya nī kro dha ni pra ti kro dha ni ha na ha na bi ha na bi ha na sarba duṣṭa pra duṣṭan nā śa ya sarba a bha ya pra te

Protect me and my retinue from all fears, from all harms, and from all contagious diseases! Protect us! May all my aims be accomplished in this place! Thus:

khi di khi di cum bhe sarba satva hi te ra te na maḥ sarba buddhā nāṃ svā hā

"Lord of the gods, if one ties this vidyā-mantra of forty-one phrases that grants fearlessness to all in knots upon a thread and binds it on, or ties a knot in one's hair, or recites it, or enchants white mustard seed or bezoar once with the mantra and smears it on, or enchants one's armor with it, then weapons cannot harm one. One will not meet one's death through poison, nor through epidemic fever, nor through fever recurring daily, nor every second day, nor every third day, nor every fourth day, nor through fire, nor through secret mantras, nor through vetālas, nor through poison, nor through disease, nor through water.

"It renders unsuccessful all the vidyā-mantras, secret mantras, and rites of accomplishment applied by those who wield them. It makes those rites that have been applied and accomplished unassailable by others. It frees from bonds imposed by adversaries. It cuts off the spells of others. It increases one's own spells. It destroys all grahas. Should any graha not let go, its head

will split into seven pieces, like the blossom of the arjaka plant."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, vanished from that very spot. The Blessed One having spoken thus, Śakra, lord of the gods, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Granting Fearlessness to All."

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor-translator Bandé Yeshé Dé, then revised according to the new language standard and finalized.

Translator's Notes

• "Dānavas" renders a term that literally means "sons of the giving woman." It is taken here as the offspring of Danu. "Skanda graha and skandas" renders a term that literally means "the suppressor," which some dhāraṇī translations use for skanda. Both identifications are probable but not certain. "Revatīs" renders a term that names the Revatī asterism. The fevers "daily, every second day," and so on are the recurring quotidian, tertian, and similar fevers of Indian medicine. "Videha, king of mountains" follows the Tibetan rendering of the mountain's name. It is probably the Vedisaka/Vediyaka mountain of the parallel Pali account of Śakra's visit.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.